developments and considerations, the DCGI made the decision to go ahead and grant emergency use authorization to Bharat Biotech's Covaxin as well.[4]

The Opposition attacked India's decision to approve the vaccines, with several of its leaders questioning their authenticity. Anand Sharma, MP of the Indian National Congress, said to the media regarding Covishield, 'The DCGI statement is puzzling and the government must reveal the final data of global efficacy trials and the final trials in UK which has been shared officially by UK's MHRA following a government-to-government agreement signed between the two countries which should be put in the public domain to avoid any confusion on the proven efficacy of the vaccine.'[5] As deputy leader of the Congress in the Rajya Sabha, one would expect Sharma to have the wisdom that India would not and should not need to sign any agreements with governments of other countries to validate the safety of its own vaccines which had gone through the process of conducting rigorous bridge trials in the country and were to be Made in India. To add fuel to the fire and undermine the credibility of our vaccines, Shashi Tharoor of the Congress also continued the rhetoric, 'Covaxin has not yet had Phase 3 trials. Approval was premature and could be dangerous. @drharshvardhan should please clarify. Its use should be avoided till full trials are over. India can start with the AstraZeneca vaccine in the meantime.'[6] Tharoor, as an active MP, had to have been clearly aware of the dangers of emerging variants and also very familiar with the proficiency of our scientists compounded with the urgent needs of keeping the country safe. The interim data submitted by Bharat Biotech was solid. The technology platform which their vaccine was based on has proven its safety in other vaccines for decades. There was no need whatsoever, at such a critical juncture with the second wave of the virus looming that the Covaxin approval should have been postponed. However, Tharoor chose to politicize the vaccine approval instead of being supportive in what would take India on the centre stage in the world order and end up saving millions of lives. The devil lies in the details, they say; notice how Tharoor carefully avoided mention of SII in his tweet. This is not an oversight. It is deliberate—so as to give off the impression that AstraZeneca is not an India-made vaccine. Repeated wordplay like this is an often-used ploy to create or change the course of a narrative towards desired goals and Tharoor is the undisputed master of the craft of diplomatic wordplay. Meanwhile, Akhilesh Yadav,